

Pengyu Zhang

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Summary

Computer Science Ph.D. candidate (UvA, expected 2027) working on temporally robust multi-modal machine learning. I build deep learning models that fuse graph structure, text, images, and time for entity linking and recommendation. My methods beat prior state-of-the-art by up to 20% on entity linking and 10% on recommendation, with the largest gains on the ambiguous cases where models fail most. Open to industry roles (Data Scientist / ML Engineer) and postdoctoral positions.

Skills

Research	Multi-modal knowledge graphs, entity linking, link prediction, recommendation, large language models.
Programming	Python, PostgreSQL, Bash, Git, Linux.
ML & DL	PyTorch, Hugging Face, scikit-learn, NumPy, Pandas; vision-language models, graph neural networks, contrastive learning.
Languages	Chinese (native); English (fluent, IELTS 7.0); Dutch (elementary).

Experience

UvA	PhD Researcher, Intelligent Data Engineering Lab (INDElab) 2022 – present • Full-time research on multi-modal machine learning, taking projects from idea to publication at CIKM, ECAI, ESWC, LREC, and the ACL Student Research Workshop. • Released three public benchmarks (GCL-TempEL, Graph-TempEL, Fusion Bench) and maintain the open-source code for every first-author project. • Train and evaluate on datasets up to 5.4M entities and 2M+ samples on A100 and H100 GPUs.
TimeRoute	Time-aware recommendation <i>Under review</i> • Raised recommendation accuracy by up to 10% on TikTok, Amazon-Baby, and Amazon-Sports over strong baselines. • Recommenders usually mix a user's clicks, text, and images the same way no matter when each happened. Built a model that learns which of these matter over short versus long time spans, and that cleans up noisy or missing history on its own.
CYCLE & TIGER	Temporally robust entity linking <i>CIKM 2024 & ECAI 2024</i> • CYCLE beat the best prior method by 13.9% to 17.8%; TIGER beat the strongest baseline by 16% to 21%, measured over one to three year gaps. • Models that match text to a database lose accuracy as the database changes from year to year. CYCLE learns from those yearly changes, and TIGER also uses how records connect to each other. Both come with public benchmarks (GCL-TempEL and Graph-TempEL).
Beyond Images	Knowledge-graph data enrichment <i>ESWC 2026</i> • Raised match accuracy by up to 7% overall, and by up to 333% on ambiguous logos and symbols. • Many records have missing or low-quality images, which hurts matching. Built a pipeline that finds extra images online, turns them into text with vision-language models, and writes a summary with an LLM, filling the gaps with no manual work.

Time Imprint	Multi-modal entity disambiguation <i>Under review</i> • Raised top-match accuracy by up to 6.07% overall, and by up to 58% on the hardest, most look-alike cases. • Systems often mix up near-identical records whose text and images look almost the same. Added time as an extra clue so the model can tell them apart, cutting errors most where they were worst.
Graph-TempCZ	Large-scale graph link prediction <i>LREC 2026</i> • Raised test accuracy by 5.98% (to 92.88%) with a GraphSAGE GNN over feature-based XGBoost baselines. • Built the first large graph linking research papers to the software they use, with over six million mentions spanning 1959 to 2022, and checked how well the model predicts usage in later years.
Fusion Training	Hybrid-reasoning LLMs <i>ACL 2026 SRW</i> • Found that interleaving thinking and non-thinking training data keeps both abilities strong. Released the Fusion Bench benchmark. • Newer LLMs mix quick answers with long step-by-step reasoning to save compute, but putting both into one model makes them fight. Ran a full grid over data ratios and training orders to see what keeps both working.

Education

2022 – present	Ph.D. in Computer Science (expected 2027), University of Amsterdam (UvA), The Netherlands. Supervisors: Prof. Dr. Paul Groth , Dr. Klim Zaporojets .
2019 – 2022	M.Eng. in Control Engineering , Beijing University of Technology (BJUT), China. Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Yong Zhang .

Awards, Talks & Service

Awards	Conference travel grant, ACL 2026; Outstanding Master's Thesis, Beijing University of Technology (2022).
Talks	Conference paper presentations at ACL 2026, ESWC 2026, LREC 2026, EKAU 2024, CIKM 2024, and ECAI 2024.
Service	Reviewer or sub-reviewer for CIKM, ECAI, ESWC, and PKDD.
Teaching	Teaching assistant, Data Engineering, Beijing University of Technology (2020 – 2021).

Publications

- TimeRoute: Time-Scale Experts for Multi-Modal Diffusion Recommendation. **Pengyu Zhang**, Yangqin Jiang, Klim Zaporojets, Congfeng Cao, Paul Groth. Under review.
- Time Imprint: Learning Time-Aware Representations in Multi-Modal Knowledge Graphs. **Pengyu Zhang**, Klim Zaporojets, Congfeng Cao, Jia-Hong Huang, Paul Groth. Under review.
[arXiv](#)
- Fusion Training for Mathematical Generalization in Large Language Models. Congfeng Cao, **Pengyu Zhang**, Jelke Bloem. ACL 2026 (Student Research Workshop).
[Paper](#) [DOI](#) [Code](#)
- Are a Thousand Words Better Than a Single Picture? Beyond Images: A Framework for Multi-Modal Knowledge Graph Dataset Enrichment. **Pengyu Zhang**, Klim Zaporojets, Jie Liu, Jia-Hong Huang, Paul Groth. ESWC 2026.
[Paper](#) [DOI](#) [Code](#) [Demo](#) [YouTube](#) [Bilibili](#)
- Graph-TempCZ: A Graph Representation of Software Mentions for Predicting Software Usage in Scientific Publications. Congfeng Cao, **Pengyu Zhang**, Jelke Bloem. LREC 2026.
[Paper](#) [DOI](#) [Code](#)
- A Survey of Large Language Models for Data Challenges in Graphs. Mengran Li, **Pengyu Zhang**, Wenbin Xing, Yijia Zheng, Klim Zaporojets, Junzhou Chen, Ronghui Zhang, Yong Zhang, Siyuan

Gong, Jia Hu, Xiaolei Ma, Zhiyuan Liu, Paul Groth, Marcel Worring. Expert Systems with Applications (ESWA) 2025.

 [Paper](#)  [DOI](#)  [Code](#)

- Understanding the Impact of Entity Linking on the Topology of Entity Co-occurrence Networks for Social Media Analysis. James Nevin, **Pengyu Zhang**, Dimitar Dimitrov, Michael Lees, Paul Groth, Stefan Dietze. EKAW 2024.

 [Paper](#)  [DOI](#)  [Code](#)

- CYCLE: Cross-Year Contrastive Learning in Entity-Linking. **Pengyu Zhang**, Congfeng Cao, Klim Zaporozets, Paul Groth. CIKM 2024.

 [Paper](#)  [DOI](#)  [Code](#)

- TIGER: Temporally Improved Graph Entity Linker. **Pengyu Zhang**, Congfeng Cao, Paul Groth. ECAI 2024.

 [Paper](#)  [DOI](#)  [Code](#)

- Relationship Updating Network with Contrastive Learning. **Pengyu Zhang**, Yong Zhang, Xinglin Piao, Yongliang Sun, Baocai Yin. Physica A 2024.

 [Paper](#)  [DOI](#)  [Code](#)

- MVMA-GCN: Multi-view Multi-layer Attention Graph Convolutional Networks. **Pengyu Zhang**, Yong Zhang, Jingcheng Wang, Baocai Yin. EAAI 2023.

 [Paper](#)  [DOI](#)  [Code](#)

- Visual Analysis for Name Disambiguation of Academic Papers (in Chinese). **Pengyu Zhang**, Yong Zhang, Yanjie Cui, Baocai Yin. JCAD 2022.

 [Paper](#)  [DOI](#)  [Code](#)  [Demo](#)  [YouTube](#)  [Bilibili](#)

- Dual-Channel Heterogeneous Graph Network for Author Name Disambiguation. Xin Zheng, **Pengyu Zhang**, Yanjie Cui, Rong Du, Yong Zhang. Information 2021.

 [Paper](#)  [DOI](#)  [Code](#)